

Mapping Money: What World Bank Loans Reveal About Countries in Need

Engaging Opening Paragraph:

When I first started exploring data analytics, I never imagined how much insight could be gained from a single dataset. One particular moment stood out during my recent project: I was analyzing World Bank data and stumbled upon a surprising trend related to loans and overpayments by countries. It felt like piecing together a puzzle where each loan told a unique story.

Why THIS Project?

I chose this project because I wanted to sharpen my SQL skills while tackling a real-world issue. Understanding the flow of money through loans can guide better economic strategies and support for nations. Plus, the challenge of working with such a large dataset excited me and pushed me to grow.

What Readers Will Gain:

By reading this article, you'll learn how SQL can be a powerful tool for analyzing financial data. You'll gain insights into global lending patterns and understand which countries are more reliant on loans and why some have zero loans.

Key Takeaways:

- India leads with the highest number of loans (58,339).
- Countries like Bangladesh and Pakistan follow closely behind.
- A surprising finding was that Mozambique has overpaid, resulting in a negative amount due to the IDA.
- Many Asian countries show up with zero loans.

Dataset Details:

The dataset I worked with came from the World Bank, containing over 1 million rows. This extensive data was perfect for identifying trends and patterns in loan distributions across various countries. It gave me a solid foundation for exploring the relationships between geography and lending.

Analysis Process:

In my analysis, I started by cleaning the data to ensure accuracy. I then used SQL queries to extract key information and visualize the results. I was fascinated by how intuitive SQL is; I often found myself pleasantly surprised by the insights I could gather quickly. One of my

biggest surprises was learning that the amount due to the IDA could actually be negative, highlighting cases where countries like Mozambique have overpaid.

Visuals and Insights:



```
SELECT country, COUNT(*) FROM "banking_data" GROUP BY "country" order by count(*) desc limit 20;
```

	Country	count_star()
1	India	58339
2	Bangladesh	40980
3	Pakistan	35203
4	Tanzania	34061
5	Ghana	30849
6	Ethiopia	26495
7	Senegal	25991
8	Yemen, Republic of	25572
9	Uganda	25139
10	Kenya	25007
11	Madagascar	23255
12	Malawi	22850
13	Nepal	22088
14	Vietnam	21662
15	Burkina Faso	21450
16	Mali	20876
17	Mozambique	19120
18	Congo, Democratic Re...	18998
19	China	18626
20	Rwanda	18375



```
SELECT region, "Due to IDA" AS due FROM "banking_data" LIMIT 20;
```

	Region	due
1	LATIN AMERICA AND ...	0
2	EASTERN AND SOUTH...	0
3	SOUTH ASIA	0
4	LATIN AMERICA AND ...	0
5	LATIN AMERICA AND ...	0
6	EAST ASIA AND PACIFIC	0
7	EAST ASIA AND PACIFIC	0
8	SOUTH ASIA	0
9	EAST ASIA AND PACIFIC	0
10	LATIN AMERICA AND ...	0
11	SOUTH ASIA	0
12	LATIN AMERICA AND ...	0
13	SOUTH ASIA	0
14	SOUTH ASIA	0
15	SOUTH ASIA	0
16	SOUTH ASIA	0
17	EAST ASIA AND PACIFIC	0
18	MIDDLE EAST AND N...	0
19	SOUTH ASIA	0
20	EASTERN AND SOUTH...	0

This table illustrates the number of loans owed by country. It's intriguing to note that India, Bangladesh, and Pakistan, located in the same region, have the highest loan counts. Understanding why these countries have higher loans could lead to discussions about

economic challenges specific to this area. Interestingly, many Asian countries have zero loans, which prompts further exploration into their financial statuses.

```
SELECT SUM("Due to IDA") FROM
"banking_data";
```

	sum("Due to IDA")
1	20164338829274.426

```
SELECT MIN("Due to IDA"), MAX("Due to IDA") FROM
banking_data;
```

	min("Due to IDA")	max("Due to IDA")
1	-5.37	793256127.64

This visualization shows the total, maximum, and minimum amounts due to the IDA. The stark contrast between the maximum due and the negative amount from Mozambique

illustrates the complexities of international loans. It makes me wonder about the financial management practices in these countries and how they affect their loan statuses.

Main Takeaways:

- SQL is a powerful tool for uncovering insights in large datasets.
- Countries in close proximity tend to have similar lending patterns, which can inform economic policies.
- Understanding the reasons behind countries having zero loans can open up conversations about their financial stability and development strategies.
- The nuances of overpayments, like in Mozambique's case, are vital for understanding the full picture of international lending.

Conclusion and Personal Reflections:

This project taught me the importance of data in shaping our understanding of global financial systems. One challenge I faced was navigating the vast amount of data, but I learned to break it down into manageable parts. This experience has not only improved my SQL skills but also deepened my interest in how data analytics can impact policy decisions. I now feel more prepared to tackle future projects with confidence.

Call To Action:

I invite you to connect with me on LinkedIn to discuss data analytics or any insights you might have on global lending. If you or someone you know is looking to hire a data analyst, let's talk! I'd love to hear your thoughts, so feel free to leave a comment with your questions.